

Chapter 56-1

Shen Hui's appearance startled both of them.

Xu Qingzhu had never seen her before and didn't recognize her, but from what she said, she could tell that her relationship with Zhao Xuning was not simple.

She had heard Bai Weiwei mention before that Zhao Xuning had an ex-girlfriend.

She'd heard that their love was deeply engraved in their hearts, causing Zhao Xuning to never be able to move on.

Only an ex who didn't part on good terms could say such things. Xu Qingzhu immediately explained: "You might have misunderstood, we're not a couple."

Shen Hui raised an eyebrow, her every frown and smile radiating charm.

It was a kind of charm tinged with coldness, yet it didn't make anyone feel offended at all.

Anyone who saw her would be momentarily lost in thought.

Simply because of her temperament and beauty.

This kind of beauty wasn't something that looks alone could determine—it was that kind of lofty temperament that didn't make people feel annoying.

It was an arrogance that made people instinctively submit.

Xu Qingzhu was inwardly amazed by this woman's beauty, but showed no expression on her face, remaining calm and indifferent as always. "I'm already married."

She said this while showing her ring.

But Shen Hui smiled with curved lips: "If you're married, then I'd advise you to stay away from certain people."

Xu Qingzhu was puzzled: "What do you mean?"

"Some people are not picky about what they eat¹." Shen Hui said meaningfully: "You might be innocent, but some people aren't."

"Shen, Hui." Zhao Xuning almost gritted her teeth as she called out this name, saying word by word: "This is a hospital."

"So what?" Shen Hui raised an eyebrow, still acting recklessly: "Can't I speak?"

She stared intently at Zhao Xuning, as if the moment Zhao Xuning denied it, her palm could slap Zhao Xuning's face.

Even Xu Qingzhu quietly moved toward the edge, afraid of being caught up in the crossfire between them.

She thought Zhao Xuning would respond very firmly.

After all, this was Zhao Xuning's workplace, a place that was sacred and inviolable to her. No matter who caused trouble here, they would receive Zhao Xuning's cold face.

But the usually calm and rational Zhao Xuning, who was normally abnormally composed, just glanced over. Across several meters, that gaze was lingering and entangled, her voice softening, only able to say without any lethal force: "Don't make trouble."

It seemed like acting coquettish².

Also seemed like begging for mercy.

It wasn't the kind of begging from being beaten or threatened.

It was more like the tender banter between young lovers.

Xu Qingzhu's eyes nearly fell out of their sockets. She swallowed, and in this quiet environment, it sounded particularly clear.

So both pairs of eyes looked over at her.

Xu Qingzhu's heart tightened, and she immediately said: "You two talk, I'll go check on my wife."

After saying this, she immediately walked toward the hospital room.

After she entered the room, this section of the corridor became quiet. Not far away were other hospital rooms, with people coming and going in the hospital, various sounds all mixed together.

But only their area seemed to have a line drawn around it.

Completely out of place with the entire world.

Shen Hui had both hands in her coat pockets, standing straight.

Zhao Xuning was the first to walk toward her. She was slightly taller, looking at Shen Hui, her voice softer than usual, that clear and cold tone carrying a few notes of tenderness, saying in a low voice: "How did you come here?"

Shen Hui raised an eyebrow, sharply asking back: "Can't I come?"

"You can." Zhao Xuning also had both hands in her white coat pockets, with a somewhat submissive meaning, saying softly: "Want to have a drink?"

Shen Hui snorted lightly: "Do you think I came to reminisce with you?"

"No matter what it's for." Zhao Xuning said: "You have time for a drink together, right?"

"No." Shen Hui firmly refused, then frowned: "Doctor Zhao, you're still like this—showing interest everywhere, being caring everywhere."

Zhao Xuning was helpless: "I don't, it's because of you..."

"Because of me what?" Shen Hui interrupted her words, sneering: "Because of me you show interest everywhere? Or are you saying that because you were hurt by me, you go everywhere talking about your pain to attract women's attention?"

Zhao Xuning: "I don't. Shen Hui, can you listen to me properly?"

"Sorry." Shen Hui said coldly: "You no longer have the qualification to make me listen to you properly."

Zhao Xuning was momentarily speechless.

She looked at Shen Hui with eyes full of lingering love, her eye sockets slightly red. Even though Shen Hui was being so harsh with her, she didn't get angry.

All she felt was a deep sense of powerlessness.

She should have known long ago that once she lost her trust, this would be the result.

Zhao Xuning couldn't help but say: "Are you not eating properly again?"

Shen Hui frowned, asking coldly: "Is that related to you?"

"You've lost weight again." Zhao Xuning ignored her coldness, only saying softly: "Will you come eat with me?"

"Zhao Xuning, can't you understand human speech?" Shen Hui looked at her viciously, those eyes like a knife, as if she wanted to pierce Zhao Xuning with a thousand holes. But when she met her gaze, she restrained herself slightly, turning her face away: "We're no longer in a relationship where we can eat together."

"Then what do you want?" Zhao Xuning asked.

Shen Hui: "....."

Her words were momentarily blocked.

Footnotes:

¹ "葷素不忌" - A Chinese idiom literally meaning "eating both meat and vegetables without discrimination," but here used metaphorically to mean someone who is not picky about romantic partners, implying promiscuity.

² "撒嬌" - A Chinese concept referring to acting cute or coquettish to get attention or affection, often used by someone in a relationship to their partner.

Author's Note: This appears to be part of Chapter 56, showing a confrontational scene between Shen Hui and Zhao Xuning in a hospital corridor, with Xu Qingzhu caught in the middle of their drama.